

Lesson 6: Climbing With Confidence

Nikki Anosike

Raise your hand if you've ever felt out of your depth at work? OK, I see you! I see some men's hands up too! Confidence is a crucial asset for success in any professional environment. However, for many women, maintaining and bolstering their confidence can be challenging.

Why? Well, workplace stereotypes that portray women as less competent, assertive, or capable of leadership can undermine anyone's confidence. The underrepresentation of women in senior leadership positions can also erode female confidence. Many times, the culprit is simply our own perfectionism and a fear of failure.

That's why, in this lesson, you'll learn how to view challenges as opportunities. You see, our interpretation of events *significantly* influences our reactions and decisions. When faced with a difficult situation, we have two primary choices: we can see it as a threat or as a chance to learn and grow.

Viewing challenges as opportunities requires a deliberate shift in mindset. It involves recognizing that every setback carries the potential for a valuable lesson, a new skill, or a chance to build resilience. Failure is often seen as the opposite of success, but in reality, it is a key component of the learning process. Each failure highlights areas for improvement and making us better. Pat was a big believer in learning from failure. In the business world, this concept is known as "failing forward."

For individuals like you and me, adopting a "fail-forward" mindset can lead to immense personal growth. When we stop fearing failure, we become more willing to step out of our comfort zones and take on new challenges. This openness to new experiences can lead to unexpected opportunities and achievements that we might have otherwise missed. Challenges also test our resilience, the ability to bounce back from adversity.

Instead of thinking, "Why is this happening to me?" ask, "What can I learn from this?" or "How can this situation make me stronger?"